

To rewrite a proxy rule in Next.js that acts **after** an API response is received (e.g., to modify body content), you cannot use `next.config.js` rewrites, as they only map incoming requests. Instead, use **Next.js Middleware** (or Proxy in v16+) to intercept the response, or create a **custom API Route handler** to fetch, modify, and return the response. [Next.js +3](#)

Method 1: Using Custom API Route Handler (Recommended for Body Modification)

This approach allows you to call an external API, receive the response, traverse/modify it, and send it back. [🔗](#)

1. **Create a handler:** `pages/api/proxy-handler.js` (or `.ts`)
2. **Use `fetch` to get the response, modify it, and return it.** [🔗](#)

javascript

```
// pages/api/proxy-handler.js
export default async function handler(req, res) {
  // 1. Fetch the original API response
  const response = await fetch('https://external-api.com/data', {
    method: req.method,
    headers: { 'Content-Type': 'application/json' },
    body: req.body ? JSON.stringify(req.body) : null,
  });

  // 2. Parse the response
  const data = await response.json();

  // 3. Traverse/Modify the data
  const modifiedData = {
    ...data,
    modifiedField: 'New Value',
    timestamp: new Date().toISOString(),
  };

  // 4. Send back the modified response
  res.status(200).json(modifiedData);
}
```

Method 2: Using Middleware (For Header/Path Manipulation) [🔗](#)

If the goal is to modify headers or rewrite the path based on the response, use Middleware. [Next.js](#)

javascript

```
// middleware.js
import { NextResponse } from 'next/server';

export function middleware(request) {
  // Check if it's the specific API route
  if (request.nextUrl.pathname.startsWith('/api/proxy')) {
    // Example: Rewriting the request internally to a different endpoint
    return NextResponse.rewrite(new URL('/api/final-endpoint', request.url));
  }
}

export const config = {
  matcher: '/api/proxy/:path*',
};
```

Summary of Differences

- **next.config.js Rewrites:** Only maps URL A to URL B (masking).
- **API Routes:** Good for modifying body content, fetching from external APIs, and adding authentication headers.
- **Middleware:** Good for modifying request/response headers before they leave or after they come back, or directing traffic.  Next.js +3